She glanced in the direction of the forest path. If she returned to Reinhardt, she'd be trapped, unable to get out. He'd told her she'd be in danger after the Soviets arrived. But what was keeping her here now, while one world was dying and the new one had yet to be born? Today might be her only chance to escape. It would be too risky for him, a Gestapo officer, to come after her. She smiled. All his carefully laid plans would be for naught. Everything was possible and in her grasp, if she only dared to reach out and take it. *Go!* She turned away from the forest path and toward the train station.

Rose heard a low-pitched roar, like the pistons in the machines on the factory floor. An early morning convoy of Panzer tanks? But the ground was still. She began to run, willing herself to go faster. After she passed the train station, she'd be off the main rain road and could take a side one. The sound became more precise. She recognized the rumble of airplane engines. Pulse thumping, she pushed the panic and dread aside and ran.

Whee-oo. Boom. A violent wave of air snatched Rose up, arcing her through space as if she was as light as a twig before dropping her hard on the ground with a thundering snap. Shards of glass and stone pummeled the ground around her. She tried to breathe, but her lungs felt like they were all pressure, but no air.

Rose attempted to stand but could only stagger up on her knees. Her ribs seared with a white-hot pain. She glanced at the factory on her right—a bomb crater in the middle—blown to shreds. Her head weighed like an anchor, pulling her down. No sound. She was underwater. Wobbling, unsteady, she saw the plane making a second pass, a machine gun poked from the window. She slid low to the ground, huddled behind a rock, and covered her head with her arms. A whoosh of hot air. Strafe hit the ground. Dust and dirt in her mouth and nose. Her lower leg burned, a searing pain like knives slicing her spine. She blacked out.

* * *

Rose opened her eyes. She was in the farmhouse, in the room she'd left when the moonlight shone through the window. Her body ached, her leg wild with pain.

"Would you like water?" A young woman's voice.